physics to fill all the available jobs for physicists. But by 1971, the American Institute of Physics job placement service had 1,053 applicants for a grand total of fifty-three jobs. No wonder, then, that the pragmatic allure of good work in other fields was no longer enough to keep the Fundamental Fysiks Group from puzzling over the foundations of quantum physics—and no wonder that John Clauser had trouble finding work when even "respectable" physicists were out of a job.

Finding a job wasn't Clauser's only worry. His experimental results were also being called into question. A second test of Bell's inequality, conducted by Holt and Francis Pipkin at Harvard, directly contradicted Clauser's results—they found that Bell's inequality held, suggesting that nature was local and quantum physics was wrong. Another experiment was needed to break the tie. At Berkeley, Clauser set up a modified version of Holt and Pipkin's experiment, hoping again to find that quantum physics was wrong. Meanwhile, Ed Fry and Randall Thompson at Texas A&M University set up a similar experiment but used cutting-edge "tunable" lasers to dramatically cut down on the time needed to collect the data. In 1976, both Clauser and the Texas team announced their results: quantum mechanics was vindicated, and Clauser and Freedman's original result stood. Quantum nonlocality was real.

But Clauser's continuing work in quantum foundations still stood in the way of finding a permanent job. Few physicists valued his work. One of the exceptions, unsurprisingly, was John Bell. In the spring of 1975, Bell and d'Espagnat started organizing a conference on experimental tests of the foundations of quantum physics, to be held the next spring in Erice, a small town on the coast of Sicily, with Clauser planned as one of the guests of honor. Bell sent a letter inviting him, but Clauser, still hunting for a job, didn't write back immediately, because he wasn't sure where he'd be the next year. After waiting for a month, Bell, worried by Clauser's silence, sent him an urgent telex. "WITHOUT YOU MEETING WOULD BE HAMLET WITHOUT PRINCE," Bell wrote. "MAY WE PUT YOUR NAME ON THE POSTER?" Clauser happily accepted, and traveled to Erice in April 1976 to bask in the professional recognition that he had thus far been denied.